

Site A, Instructor Interview 1

[0:00:00.0] **Site A Instructor:** [0:00:03.0] Fascinating. It announces it's recording now.

Interviewer: [0:00:06.0] Yeah. Isn't that interesting? It gives you an out if you're uncomfortable with it. Yeah. So just to get a started, [Site A Instructor], can you just tell tell me a little bit about the course that you'll be teaching this semester?

Site A Instructor: [0:00:21.0] Yeah, it's, it's [Advanced Qualitative 3], So [Advanced Qualitative 3]. So these are all advanced doctoral students. All of them, with the exception of one, I think are either getting the qual PhD or the qual certificate. I inherited the class a couple of years ago, I guess, and when I got it it was really close to the start of the semester. And so I inherited the syllabus and I'm reading through the syllabus and I'm like, I don't, I don't quite know exactly what this class is supposed to do. I don't, I don't know what the aim, the goal, the dream, the hope is here. I had taught [Introductory Qualitative 1 and 2] for a while, so I understood what that sequencing was about and so and I had changed [Introductory Qualitative 2] pretty drastically in the range of ways and so we'd had conversations as a program about [Introductory Qualitative 2] is doing now what [Introductory Qualitative 1] was doing now. But it was clear that [Advanced Qualitative 3] had, had just had not changed in many years. And so the first year that I taught it, I was actually fortunate enough to have a group of students that I think there was one student in the class that I had never taught before, and the others I'd actually had in a number of classes. And I was just really upfront with them and I'm like, I'm going to teach them the syllabus that I've inherited because I don't have time to make bricks without straw Old Testament style here. But I don't know what the hell we're doing. I don't know what the aim is, I don't know what the goals are like.

Site A Instructor: [0:01:56.0] I can see the student objectives that are listed in the syllabus, but I don't quite follow how what's laid out is supposed to get us there. And so the entirety of that semester was just them and me interrogating that class, thinking through like, what should it do? What do students need for it to do following the sequencing of [Introductory Qualitative 1 and 2]. And so anyway. And so now I've taught it, I think three times now I don't really know. And I'm trying to decide if, like the COVID year counts, I don't know, like the whole weird hybrid thing that we did last year. But I feel like and [DAY OF WEEK] was our first day of class. And so we talked about like [Introductory Qualitative 1] is I feel like just enough for them to be dangerous. Like it's wading into the water ankle deep. A lot of the students are there because they have to be because their programs require that as a research methods class. So I'm sure it's the same at [interviewer's institution] and then [Introductory Qualitative 2] you you waded in up to at least like mid thigh, right. And they really start to engage in like what are theoretical and conceptual frameworks, what do they matter? What do you do with them? They start to actively engage in like data production, data analysis and thinking through those theoretically. And so then [Advanced Qualitative 3] is really meant to interrogate all of that because I feel like [Introductory Qualitative 1 and 2] are so focused on this is what qual is, this is how you do qual, that there isn't a whole lot of questioning of.

Site A Instructor: [0:03:28.0] Is it okay that we do it that way? Is this the right way to do it? Is this the best way to do it? Is this the most ethical way to do it? And I will also say that one of the things that I was really surprised by, but really pleased by [my institution] is that while our undergraduate population is [predominantly white and upper socioeconomic status], like over [half] of those students are from out of state.

Interviewer: [0:03:53.0] Really.

Site A Instructor: [0:03:54.0] The, the doctoral population is very diverse. And and there is a [significant] number of international students and a [significant] number of black women and a [significant] number of queer students who are in these classes. And so. I was not prepared for that, but I was really excited by that. And so one of the things that [Advanced Qualitative 3] does as it interrogates, like, why do we do qual this way? Is this, is this the appropriate way to do qual? Why are we not thinking through, you know, the things that we take for granted? And and part of it to the things that we started doing. I apologize. One of the things we started doing this year, I've never done it before, but I'm excited about doing it is that we're starting the semester. One of the [early] meetings they have is Tuck and Yang's discussion of what they call pedagogies of refusal, and like this idea of like refusing the status quo, refusing taken for granted norms, refusing to colonize research, refusing to be colonized by research. And so one of their [early] tasks is they're going to read. They're going to actually they're going to read one of Betsy Peters papers where she's like, you know, no data, no decoding.

Site A Instructor: [0:05:18.0] And then another one, by you know, the one by Lincoln and ((unclear)), where it's like, again, like, let's think about like this. Like methodological standardization. And so you know they're reading those discussions and their thinking, and they're starting to. They're starting to disrupt a lot of things about what they think they know about qual. But then also thinking through, like through this pedagogy of refusal, like even as we're working to disrupt these norms, these conversations that like St. Pierre and Lincoln are having. How potentially are even those conversations problematic? What are those conversations doing that are meant to be disruptive, that are potentially even reifying? And so anyway and so the students have referred to it in the course evaluations as the Mindfuck class. And I think that's kind of good, frankly. And so we read a lot of really hard stuff. We do a lot of, I think what are really challenging things. There's also a lot of like self interrogation in the class. But anyway, so that's like so the class has ultimately taken shape to be something that works to push students to question all that they think they know now because now they've arrived at a point where they're very advanced and they really think they've got a handle on qual. All of them are doing either a qualitative or a mixed methods dissertation, and so they feel equipped and it's like, awesome. What do we not know? And what do you maybe know wrong or problematically? So that's what.

Interviewer: [0:07:00.0] That sounds awesome. Could you send me the syllabus?

Site A Instructor: [0:07:03.0] Yeah. I totally will write right now before I forget.

Interviewer: [0:07:06.0] Yeah, that sounds. That sounds like a fantastic. I would like to enroll. Fantastic course. You kind of already mentioned this already, but so you said they're

generally advanced students. Some of them are in the methods program, some of them are from other programs. Can you talk a little bit more about like the typical student that's in the class?

Site A Instructor: [0:07:29.0] Yeah. I think the typical student is. The majority of them are full time doctoral students, but that doesn't mean all of them are. There's, there's still a pretty significant number of them that are either full time teachers, full time counselors, full time administrators, etc.. The majority of them come from [Education], although not exclusively. I mean, we get students from all over the university, and so we get students from like the medical school, from public health, from we get a lot of students from communications and social work. But because a lot of times they have questions that are really qualitative questions. And so the students tend to be. Because most of them are college education. Most of them tend to be older than late twenties. They tend to typically be like mid thirties, even early forties, sometimes even older than that. And that I feel like is. Is of significance because these are people who typically bring into this class a lot of lived experience. And so I think one of the reasons that qual resonates with them is because they start to have a way to articulate to other people why their lived experiences count as research. Additionally, as I mentioned, a lot of them occupy marginalized identities, and I think that's another reason that the qual resonates with them. It's because it's it's a way to to center those identities in ways that quant just, frankly, is not equipped to really do and to personalize those identities, rather than just simply to to categorize and collate them.

Site A Instructor: [0:09:25.0] And so they come from all over but most are education people. Most are full time, although you know some are not. And in terms of who they are, I think that by the time they arrive to this class, they they are past the point of knowing enough to be dangerous. I think at this point they're aware of how much they don't know. And I think that's one of the reasons the class typically works is because [Introductory Qualitative 1], they know they don't know anything. And frankly, there are a lot of times they're mad that they have to be there because they're like, I'm only here because my program requires it and then [Introductory Qualitative 2]. A lot of times they've taken some of the electives in the qualitative program before they take [Introductory Qualitative 2] sometimes not, but they know enough to be dangerous at that point, and they think they know. The electives, they always know enough to be dangerous. And they're like, you know, I know qual and I'm like. But, but you do not. But then by [Advanced Qualitative 3], that's typically like the capstone class and it's not expected to be that way, but that's typically how students arrange it in their schedules. And so they arrive very aware of, I don't know, stuff. And at that point a lot of them are ABD this is a lot of times their only class and so they are. They're very concerned. Because, so a lot of them, because they occupy marginalized identities, a lot of them are doing research relative to their dissertations that are also focusing on these these marginalized groups themselves, etc..

Site A Instructor: [0:11:04.0] And so they're very concerned about doing research right. And in some respects, I mean that like in terms of like I want to do it right, because I want to graduate, I want to do it right so that I am able to placate my committee members. But I think also do it right because like a lot of them are very aware at this point of how much research

has been done wrong and how often research has wronged. And so anyway and so it's it's a group of students that a lot of times they really they know each other typically because they've taken a lot of classes together. If nothing else, they've taken qual classes together. And they typically know me because this semester I've taught all of them but [few]. And and most of them I've had for a number of classes, some of them have actually had for, I mean, upwards of two or three or even four other classes. And I think there's at least one where it's like her entire qualitative certificate will have been with me. And that wasn't by design. We actually tried really hard to to restructure the course, the course assignment, so that they they have to get out and see new people. We encourage promiscuity. But for whatever reason, the [administrator] scheduling it just didn't work out that way. She ended up being very monogamous. So anyway, so. I feel like I'm rambling at this point, so I'm not sure what else I need to.

Interviewer: [0:12:26.0] No, it's really helpful. And are all of the students that take this class, are they generally PhD students or do you all have a mix of EdD students?

Site A Instructor: [0:12:34.0] We have we have EdD students. I will say that [SITE A'S] EdD programs are fascinating to me in that I don't even understand why they have them because not that I'm dismissing EdDs because they certainly serve a function, but we have, we seem to have two, two different versions of the EdD and one is this the seeming fast track to a doctorate for like practicing professionals, like principal superintendents and so on. The other is basically a PhD. Like, I don't even see a difference in the coursework. And there have actually been a number of students that have realized like I'm doing PhD work, like why? And so they've actually, they've, they've changed to a PhD because they're like, you know, there, there's, there's, there's no difference basically. And I understand that in academia, PhDs have a different cachet than the EdD's do. And so it's weird and I don't quite follow why there's those two different versions of it, but it seems like the fast track EdD is associated with particular cohorts. And I think frankly, some of those cohorts pay a premium for their fast track PhD and they're not typically because I'm on the [funding committee] and they're typically not awarded [funding] because they're there so briefly, I think they're they're EdD is designed to be completed in like [a few] years. And and so, I mean, they typically have a year before they're eligible for like most of these [funding opportunities] because they have to have established a record as a student.

Site A Instructor: [0:14:18.0] And then it's like they have [little time] left. And so anyway and so most of them are PhD students are always a handful of EdD students and like a handful out of 15 is, I don't know, probably [a few], but some of those started their programs as EdD students and have shifted over to PhD students because they've realized like they're doing exactly the same work as the students doing the PhDs in their program. And some of them are frankly better students, than some of the ones who enroll to get a PhD. And so any time that I've been able to advocate, I've been able to actually advocate it, if that's what they wanted to do. So, yeah, so there are some EdDs. If there are EdDs, they tend to be in either higher education or library sciences. That's where most of the and occasionally there's like a special education EdD because we actually have, we have several programs that are specifically for [minors] that are associated with the university. And so some of those people are working in

those facilities and so they come [to this institution] to get an EdD relative to that role. And so.

Interviewer: [0:15:28.0] So you wouldn't have in this course the [Advanced Qualitative 3], you wouldn't typically be working with those cohort type fast tracked EdDs.

Site A Instructor: [0:15:39.0] So, the cohort people, generally speaking, they all are grouped as a cohort together and they have a lot of times like it's it's online even and a lot of times even asynchronous with like occasional like occasional synchronous in-person meetings, like a few times a semester. And they typically have like their own [particular] faculty because like, for example, like the [health] EdD, they always take [Advanced Qualitative 3], but they have like a particular [health] cohort, faculty member that teaches a course program.

Interviewer: [0:16:17.0] Okay. So you have generally 15 students in [Advanced Qualitative 3].

Site A Instructor: [0:16:21.0] That's the cap.

Interviewer: [0:16:22.0] That's the cap. Okay, do you have 15 this semester?

Site A Instructor: [0:16:25.0] I actually had 16 until one had to drop because of scheduling.

Interviewer: [0:16:28.0] Okay. Okay. So you have a full class. So what analytic perspectives, analytic strategies or techniques do you typically introduce in [Advanced Qualitative 3]?

Site A Instructor: [0:16:40.0] So this semester I had mentioned before, like the pedagogy of refusal. I'm working to have that be an analytic frame for them. I want them because I want them to approach qual very critically. And I want this, this concept of decoloniality and anti racism in qual to be front and center. I want it to be an explicit part of what they're doing. I don't want it to be something I hope that they do. I also because some of the students are going to be doing that work because that's who they are methodologically. I don't want other students to be able to like sit back and like basically let the students that are already marginalized by those issues be the only ones who engage in that work. And so. We're going to apply that frame multiple times as a way to analyze the field, analyze literature, analyze data. Like what does it mean to refuse the status quo? What does it mean to reconceptualize data collection, data itself? Data analysis with this notion of refusal and I don't know what the answers are yet because we haven't quite done it this way before. I feel like I've tap danced around this for the past [semesters] and now we're doing it. And I will say the Tuck and Yang article actually starts with this engagement with coding. And so that's one of the things that we're doing is we're actually reading several articles that are specifically about like really troubling like this, this, this taken for grantedness of coding in qualitative research.

Site A Instructor: [0:18:16.0] And so, you know, what do we mean by that? What do we what did you learn that that was through coursework? What have you learned that that is through potentially work that you've done with various faculty members? If you're coding through your dissertation, like what does that look like? What do you mean by that? But if we

have this, this, this tried and true notion of data analysis in qual, I mean, it's typically just sort of the it's not the gold standard as much as it's the standard. But then we all have different philosophical understandings and notions of what that means. We all have different attachments of what ethics are in relation to like what does that mean and what does it mean for you as a researcher? What does it mean for qualitative inquiry in general if you start to interrogate in trouble that. I, I've written [scholarship during my career] and a number of them have taken classes where we've engaged with these conversations. But like looking at, well, you know, like looking at the consent process and troubling that, but also like transcription too. Like I've [addressed] transcription because I just, I can't.

Site A Instructor: [0:19:28.0] I can't wrap my head around how static of an entity that is in qualitative research generally. We create a transcript and then it just becomes this fact. The process of producing the transcript goes uninterrogated and and and so all the various decision making processes that are a part of, of all of the production of what becomes a transcript, the production of the transcript itself, the you know, the engagement with the transcript as a data source. And so and so relative to like what we're going to do this semester, that's what we're going to start with. We're using the thinking with theory book and they're going to they're going to read they're going to read that. We're going to we're going to work through that together. And I want we're doing the the notion of refusal [early in the course], because then I want them to apply that both complementary to the different discussions and the thinking theory book, but also like, like in potentially refusing aspects of what that book is saying, too. They're also reading Norman Denzin's, The Qualitative Manifesto. And one of their tasks ultimately for the class is to write their own qualitative manifesto. And so part of what they're doing is like they're they're engaging with this notion of refusal, because I feel like that's kind of what Denzin is doing, is is working to engage with this notion of refusal of a lot of what has become very standard and very static in qual.

Site A Instructor: [0:21:04.0] But like every year when students read that book, there's always like a pushback, especially from students of color, because, for example, like Denzin says, we should read more scholars of color, but then there's like a list toward the end of the book where like he names a number of scholars that people should read and students ever fail to notice, like, where are the black women? Why aren't they there? Why are there a bunch of men? You know, why are there so few women? Period. The only women who are named, why are they white women or you know, and and so, you know, also like looking at Denzin's discussion as a form of refusal, but also refusing some aspects of his discussion and then thinking through like, okay, what does that mean for you as a qualitative scholar then? Like, how does that shape who you are, how you understand and articulate yourself? And so I want that I want that framework of refusal to be a thread that is just woven throughout the entirety of the course. And so then they're going to engage with the thinking with every book like you know, they read, and we're going to engage with or like Derrida and Deleuze and Butler and Berard. And so they're going to read those, those, those people's work, and we're going to engage with those things.

Site A Instructor: [0:22:23.0] But also always reaching back to that that notion of refusal. One of the other things that we're going to read is they read it in [Introductory Qualitative 1],

but we're going to come back to it as Patricia O'Connell's discussion of the outsider insider and also thinking about that. And for many of them in relation to themselves in terms of qual, because that is how they're situated for a range of different reasons, but also like thinking about themselves in relation to their participants. Themselves, in relation to their committees. Themselves, in relation to their dissertation topics. And so like I want, I want the class to be disruptive is what I want it to be. I want it to be I want I want what they and I think we know to constantly be questioned. And so that's that's the goal, the hope, the dream. I don't know how well it will work, but they seem game for it. They seem excited about it. So and I mean and I know them all, but the one and the one, I mean, I'm sure he's great, but I know that the rest of them will definitely. I mean, they'll jump in both feet first without looking first and we'll we'll do it together, so it'll be good.

Interviewer: [0:23:37.0] That's awesome. It sounds amazing. Have you taught it this way previously or is this your first time of centering this pedagogy of refusal?

Site A Instructor: [0:23:46.0] This is the first time I've centered this because I feel like so. So I have a I have a I got a grant to do a like a data discussion data analysis group with a group of of doc students that are getting the qual PhD. And we arrived at this pedagogy refusal as part of our readings just in terms of like just rejecting norms and qual. And so one of the students that's in this, this group, this discussion group, this research group, I guess is actually like a T.A. in [Advanced Qualitative 3]. And he, but he's engaging in the class, like both as a student and as a TA. It's it's a strange thing because he can't not engage as a student because he (inaudible) he is a fellow. He's an advanced qualitative PhD student, but he is a fellow doctoral student. This isn't like a doctoral student in relation to undergraduates like he is. And so he's expected to engage in the class in many of the same ways that they do as part of assisting with the teaching. And so like this is one of the things that he and I talked about is like this might be a useful framework because he's taken this class before. And so if the class is meant to be so disruptive if the class is meant to refuse. Why not frontload that? Why not make that an explicit part of what students are being equipped to discuss and do? Because I feel like a lot of times when we're asking students to disrupt norms, that's really problematic because what we're asking to do is something that there often is not language to do. And so this is an attempt to try to. Rather than, than having them have to work around vocabulary to try to figure out how to do it. Here's a discussion, front and center, explicitly. That's I mean, basically like fuck all that, you know, and so cool. What's that mean relative to [Advanced Qualitative 3]?

Interviewer: [0:25:44.0] So you mentioned that you like in [Introductory Qualitative 1], they're introduced to coding and that a lot of them turn to that in their dissertation work. What have you found challenging about teaching coding?

Site A Instructor: [0:26:03.0] That they want a single way to do it right. I mean, I think that's the challenge. I think the other challenge is that they want to code all the things. And so something that should be an analytic tool basically becomes like a highlighting extravaganza. And and I think the other thing is in [Introductory Qualitative 1] especially, a lot of them are they're actually quantitative students, which we have fantastic quantitative faculty and their

students are great, but they come to qual and they think they know what it is. But it's a very post positivist notion of qualitative research, which is not what we do. And so from like the first day, I've actually had students in tears, not because I threatened them or tried to break them, but because I think they realize from the first start, like, like I thought I was getting into the three foot section of the pool and now I'm over here in this 12 foot section and I don't have floaties on. And so I think the other part of it is that most of the time and I think just because of the ways that we're socialized to understand and engage in research, they understand coding in very post-positivist and very positivist ways where it's like there is a way to do it. You do it this way, that is the right way to do it. And oftentimes it ends up being a quantification of findings. You know, there were this many occurrences of this and this many occurrences of this, and it's like, okay, that's cool.

Site A Instructor: [0:27:45.0] That's great job. Is that actually a significant finding that they brought that up blank number of times, or do they bring it up like number of times? Because that's how many times you ask them about that thing, right? Like is that actually a finding or is it just them cooperating with you as an interviewer? And so I think the biggest problem is that like they want a way to do it. And then software has also proven to be really, really challenging. Some of the students, like they don't understand that qualitative software doesn't like do analysis for them. And so they stick it in in vivo, they stick it in to deduce, they stick it into [QUALITATIVE SOFTWARE] and they're like, well, it's not doing anything. And I'm like, you are right. It is a holding cell with a lot of different tools and bells and whistles for you to go through and do analysis yourself. And they're like, but what does it do? And I'm like, that is what it does. Like, you, you are the research instrument and you are the data analysis instrument. And so and so they struggle with coding being something that they themselves have to do. And I think one of the things that we struggle with is really emphasizing to some of them, like you were the one making the decisions like there is there is no cop out, there is no objectivity pretense.

Site A Instructor: [0:29:04.0] You're the one who decides the research topic. You're the one who decides the research questions. You're the one who decides what what your findings are. And I think one of the biggest battles that I engage with and it's funny because anybody's whose had me for a single class like will immediately like they'll take care of it if it comes up in wordage. But when people talk about like codes emerging I'm just like no and what I always, I'm always like, all right, think about like the movie Aliens, right? Like Ripley, like the alien baby, like, emerges from her belly, like it busts through and, like, comes into the world. That's emergence, codes don't do that. You have to, you make you make them up. Right. And so that's the other part of it I think, is getting them to take responsibility for my decision making is how these codes came to be. And then thinking through like, why did I make them up in that way? How did I make those decisions? Because that's something else I feel like. So I struggle with getting them to understand that coding is something that they must do. Um, that there isn't a right way to do it. And then the other part of it is like they're not accustomed to explaining the why of research. They're just used to explaining the what. Sometimes the how, although sometimes that's lacking too, but like getting them to shift away from that what. I mean, the what's important, but like getting them to really think through the why and they'll constantly ask, well, can I do this? Can I do this? And my answer is

consistently to the point where students can just like finish the sentence for me, but I'm like, you could do whatever you want to.

Site A Instructor: [0:30:37.0] So long as it makes sense, you got to be able to explain the why. And so I think for me that's the biggest issue with coding in general is that they really struggle with the why because they want to be told the how. And so yeah. So I think that's that's the biggest challenge with coding, especially in [Introductory Qualitative 1] is and some of them also one of the other issues is that it sounds way fancier than it actually is. And so some of them think about it like almost like as an engineering-esk type thing. And I'm like in most cases, in most cases, you're literally looking for patterns, you're looking for repetition, like. You can make this fancy and convoluted and difficult if you want to. That's a choice. But one doesn't have to engage with it in that way. And so anyway, I think that getting some of them over being intimidated by the idea of coding and then getting the rest of them over the fact that it's not going to happen for them, and then getting them all over the fact that they're they're going to not have to explain the why and the how.

Interviewer: [0:31:43.0] How do you typically teach coding?

Site A Instructor: [0:31:47.0] I. I do a good bit of modeling for them. I take them through different ways that I do coding. And I'm always like, I'm emphatic, like these are ways like these are not it is not the way, I am not the way, the truth, the light. This is a way. And then one of the things that so I show them, I show them like my old school way, which is some people really like to like print things out and like highlight them or mark them. I don't do that because like it's a really big waste of paper, but I model that for them because that resonates with some of them. I show them. What I often will do is, is use like, I'll start with the research questions and I'll assign each research question like a color and I'll like highlight and then go back through and like do a reread and start to like break and parse apart things. And so I'll model that for them. And then we also have [SOFTWARE NAMES]. And so like talking to through some of that, showing them how that works, some of them are super into it. Other ones are like, no, that is that is the devil and I will not and that's all fine.

Site A Instructor: [0:33:07.0] It's totally up to them. But there's a good bit of modeling and I typically always have a doctoral teaching assistant in that class, and so they will also model ways that they do coding. Just so the point is to emphasize there's not a way, right? And then one of the other things they have to do is they have to they have to conduct an individual interview in in a way that, that we model and show them, which typically is we typically do like phenomenological interviewing just because it requires deep listening, which is something they struggle with. But then we also require that they do some sort of of nontraditional interview. And so sometimes like they'll do like photo voice or they'll do like object based or timeline based, whatever, walking interviews. And so once they've collected data in an unconventional way, we start getting them like, okay, we've talked about coding, we've talked about like, here's different ways that one can code. Now that you've done this interview in a less conventional way, what are ways that you can come at this data less conventionally as well? And so we'll do things like found poetry, narrative analysis, things

like that. Sometimes art space. Some students are very into that and it sets them up nicely to potentially take some of the electives classes that we offer.

Site A Instructor: [0:34:42.0] But it also, the goal, the hope, the dream, the aspiration, the I don't know, the pipe dream, perhaps, the utopia, is that they leave that class understanding there isn't a way to do it. I will say that and this is not necessarily one of your questions, but the biggest struggle I have is not that students don't ultimately internalize that, they seem to most of them seem to get it. Some of them are just like, okay, I get there's lots of ways to do it. I'm still doing it this way because I get it. I understand it. I will do it this way because it makes sense. And I'm like, okay, that's fine. I will not arm wrestle you or take your firstborn because you want to do it this way. That's all good. I don't want your baby. It's really faculty that, that are the ones that are like, no, we have to go back to like we have to do it this way. And that's frustrating that I feel like we work so hard to disrupt understandings of research and then faculty are like. But this is what I did way back in the day in the coal mine. And so therefore that's what you must do if I'm going to be on your dissertation.

Interviewer: [0:35:38.0] When you, so you mentioned that the students collect data. Well, do they collect new data and [Advanced Qualitative 3]? Are they using, will they be using data that they've already collected?

Site A Instructor: [0:35:54.0] Both potentially, some of them have data because a lot of them are ABD yeah, some of them are not ABD though. So we have, we have a fellows program in special education. They basically get a free PhD in special education. There's a requirement that they have to work in like some sort of facility with adjudicated youth as part of the fellowship funding. They are required to get the qual certificate.

Interviewer: [0:36:21.0] Really?

Site A Instructor: [0:36:23.0] Yes. Well, there's there's a story there, but it's because I do a lot of grant work with the with the woman who runs that fellows program.

Interviewer: [0:36:32.0] That worked out.

Site A Instructor: [0:36:33.0] Well. I mean, so so she has to bring me on constantly as methodologist because she's like, I just do a bastardized version of qual that frankly is probably really offensive. And so she's just like she's realized like, I don't know how to do this well and I refuse to graduate students who are just as unequipped I am. And so she and I talked about the qual class certificate and she's like, they're all going to take it there's space in their program and now they're going to do it. But I say that to say like they will likely not have any data because they have, some of them have taken electives, some of them have not, but they have quite literally like they did [Introductory Qualitative 1] last fall. They did [Introductory Qualitative 2] in the spring. They're doing [Advanced Qualitative 3] now. And so they are all many of them are like this is their second year as a PhD student [redacted] and and so they're not quite to that stage yet. And so some of them will collect data, and for some of them, I will potentially supply data. And so I'm always at the ready and just in case. But generally speaking, I try to encourage them to try to collect their own data.

Interviewer: [0:37:37.0] Okay.

Site A Instructor: [0:37:38.0] Because it's just. It's. Why not? It's more useful. And then plus they can take it with them or they can continue to play with it and piddle with it. So anyway, and so most of the students will have their own. Some will need to collect it, which is fine. And then there's going to be a handful that especially like, I don't know. Like, for example, if we were doing something that was specifically like talk based. Like if we were doing like conversation analysis or something and they're doing like an archival dissertation, that's, that's not going to work. Right. And so and so then they could either potentially collect their own, like, audio file based data, or I could share some with them.

Interviewer: [0:38:21.0] So when you teach data analysis and ways of thinking about the analytic process, when you're modeling, do you use your generally your own data or are you using data they collect? Or is it data that you've collected from your own research endeavors?

Site A Instructor: [0:38:38.0] It's typically, it's typically mine, although, I mean, we probably have all taught and had like, I need a volunteer. And so sometimes even in [Introductory Qualitative 1], a lot of times students will already have had well have already collected data. Some of those students are ABD and they've put off taking [Introductory Qualitative 1] because they're just like, this will hurt. And so they're at the end of their coursework. And I'm like, you know, I don't why are you here this late in your program but you know whatever I don't rule universe yet. So. And so in some cases, if they have it and they're comfortable having other people say it, I'm happy to use theirs as a way to work through it. There's also like I mean, there's plenty of examples of data excerpts like in manuscripts and so on too. And so that's also a way to do it. Like if they're reading articles where there's examples of data. I mean, that's that's a way to do it. There's also there's a there's a we have a what do they call it? It's like a data research pool here at [my institution]. It's for quantitative purposes. The, the educational neuroscience people are the ones who typically use that pool. So most of that data is actually not necessarily of interest to these students because it's like very specific things like MRI readings as a student looked at pictures or eye tracking while a kid is reading a page.

Site A Instructor: [0:40:08.0] But if the point is to show them how to code, sometimes, frankly, using something they're completely unfamiliar with is kind of useful because then they're not so stuck on the content and they can look at the process. So we can use that stuff, too. And so I've used that in the past as well. It's really just a matter of like, how well do they seem to get it? One of the things that I've done in the past is like taken on some sort of of data excerpt and put them all in like envelopes and then students can cut them if they want to. They can rearrange them if they want to. The cutting process is sometimes rather problematic because they'll cut it one way and then realize like, I actually should cut it a different way because I'm changing my mind about the codes. And then I'm like, here's tape. But, but so having them like work through that kind of stuff, to like to have it be very hands on. But yeah. So anyway, when I'm modeling, most of it is my data or the doctoral students data that's, that's, that's co teaching with me.

Interviewer: [0:41:08.0] Okay, okay.

Site A Instructor: [0:41:10.0] Or potentially students in the class's data because sometimes sometimes they'll be like, use mine. And I'm like, okay, except I'm going to use really like, I'm going to create really weird codes so you can't use them.

Interviewer: [0:41:24.0] So. Okay, so thinking. Well, let's take up the coding first. When thinking about when you're teaching coding, how do you make sense of or assess that your students have learned? What it means to code qualitatively.

Site A Instructor: [0:41:44.0] Their ability to explain how they're doing, what they're doing, and why they're doing it that way. And that's one of the things they struggle with, too, is like the end product itself is, is, is of, of less interest to me than the process itself. And I think that's that's one. So if I were to say, like, that's that's a paradigm shift that happens in the qualitative courses is that we are, it's not that we don't care about the product. We obviously do, but we're much more invested in the process. And so that's that's how they get evaluated, is the process itself. And so like when they, like when they do an interview or they do a focus group, they're not actually, they're not evaluated at all on the data collection process itself because the interview could suck. The focus group could suck. The point is, what was the quality of your reflection prior to this interview? What was the quality of your reflection post this interview? What is the quality of your explanation and reflection as you're going through and analyzing this interview? And so I think that's, that's for me is the answer is it's an evaluation of the process itself and how well they're able, how clearly they're able to articulate it and to what degree they seem to have a handle on their own process.

Site A Instructor: [0:43:04.0] Because it becomes I mean, you know, it becomes very apparent when students are describing a process that clearly is not their own. They are, they're describing a process that they feel like it's very it seems very lock step. And it's like, this is how I've been told to do something. And so I'm doing it this way. And it doesn't matter that it hurts because if it hurts, it's working. And so so, I mean, that's that's it. And they they really struggle with that because they they have long understood research. I mean, ever since, like elementary school, like you're taught that like research is about results, research is about findings. And it's like, I mean, yeah, that's part of it. And so a lot of times, like, they, they're like, 'well, I don't know what to do with this paper. I don't know. I don't know how to do this.' And it's like because you've never been asked to really explicitly interrogate your own process. But (inaudible).

Interviewer: [0:43:59.0] So if you were to take up this pedagogy of refusal and think about this upcoming semester, at the end of the semester, what are your thoughts on how you'll determine whether students have really taken up this concept and learned what it means to engage in a pedagogy of refusal?

Site A Instructor: [0:44:21.0] I don't know. That's my honest answer. I, my hope is that, by the end of this semester, because of where most of them are in their trajectory, that there will be, they do a lot of writing. They do a lot of of of reflective writing. They do a lot of self analytic writing. They do they do data analytic writing. They do a lot of writing. They do a lot of discussion on those things too. And I guess one of the things that I want them to do, is as

they're interrogating the field of qualitative research, as they're interrogating themselves, as they're interrogating the various products and processes of qualitative research, I mean, I guess my big question is like, does it, does does whatever they're describing feel authentic for them? Does it feel like this is something that is theirs. It's not just them parroting something that they've read. It's not them parodying something that they've read. It's it's something that they now feel like they have a handle on. And it's something that that it doesn't mean that they're done. I mean, I hope, in fact, that's not the case at all. But it's something that they've worked through enough that when they write it, it feels authentic and real to them, and it feels authentic and real to me, as a writer for them and as a reader for me. And I give a lot, I give a lot of feedback, a lot. I mean to the point where I think it's even overwhelming sometimes, but I don't apologize for it. And there are moments when, there are moments when I'm giving them feedback and I'll write things like 'this seems really forced' or 'I'm not sure that I follow because it doesn't feel like you quite are there yet.'

Site A Instructor: [0:46:43.0] And students consistently are like, 'you're right. You're absolutely right.' And so, I want the end of the semester to be one where, whatever they're refusing, that it makes sense to them, it's useful to them, it's meaningful to their research, and it's something that they're able to articulate in a way that is sincere. I want it to be writing that they feel from their gut and their heart rather than just their head. I mean, I don't know, like I can't articulate it any better than that. It pisses me off when I hear journal editors talk about qualitative research and they're like, 'Well, when it's good, you just know it. You just know when it's good.' And I'm like, 'Well, that's that's a useless peer review process.' But there's just, there are moments when like, there are moments when students are writing and, you know, like they've got this, like this is theirs. And that's my hope, is that by the end of it, it's theirs. And by the end of it, their final paper that they're doing, it's, they're allowed to do whatever they want. It doesn't have to be a paper. I had a student last year who actually did a thread-based project, which is great, but the whole the whole point of that was though it was hers, it belonged to her. And it felt to her and to me like an authentic it was coming from an authentic place and something she had a handle on. And so I want to try to take that effort and move it to be more critical of of research, of qual with this this framework of refusal and to think through like, how does that authenticity look and feel and sound with that framework in place?

Interviewer: [0:48:32.0] Yeah, that's that's beautiful. So I just have two more questions and then we'll talk a little bit about logistics related to the students. So first off, is there anything else that you would like to share that I perhaps haven't touched with the questions?

Site A Instructor: [0:48:49.0] Such a good qualitative question, isn't it? It's always one of my [inaudible] questions to you. I don't know. I'm going to be the bad participant and be like, no, I didn't mean, like I didn't really have expectations. It's really interesting to have these conversations about this class when it's all still so, unknown, but it's also kind of cool. Like class just started on [DAY OF WEEK]. I was uploading my syllabus. [DAY OF WEEK]. [Inaudible] things. You should be better. You should do better in life. And and I don't know. And so, like, I mean, even now I look at some of the stuff and I'm like, 'Oh, I should have done it differently, or, oh, it could have been different.' And I think that's, I mean, that's a

never ending process, right? But I don't, I feel like this is a great group of students to think through these issues with, because I'm very upfront and open with students anyway, like if I don't know something, I'm like 'I don't know.' But this is a really good group of students just because I think that like they're far enough along, all of them, even the ones, the fellows that have gone one, two, three, they're far enough along all of them to where it's like they recognize that 'I don't know' is a very legitimate place to be in research and it's a very useful place to be in research. I mean, I don't know how it's going to go, but I'm excited to do it with this group because like, they are, they're just they're really smart, they're really thoughtful. They are, they have a wickedly wonderful sense of humor. And so I think it's going to be a blast.

Interviewer: [0:50:36.0] That's awesome. I

Site A Instructor: [0:50:38.0] I can be totally wrong, but I don't think that I am. I think it's gonna be awesome.

Interviewer: [0:50:40.0] Well I feel that it's wonderful that it somehow worked out that this is the course that we're able to learn from.

Site A Instructor: [0:50:49.0] Yeah, I was thinking that, I was like, this is a really good one. The other class I was going to be teaching had I not gotten the course release was qual too. And that's like, that's a really straightforward class in terms of data analysis because it's very much like this application of theoretical frameworks. And so that's how a lot of that happens is like they, they read and engage in like critical race theory, and so they look at like, what does that mean analytically? And then feminist theories and then like, what does that mean analytically? And so thinking through like how do these different lenses as you're popping them on and off your eyeballs, like how do they change how you're engaging with the data? And so it's a really straightforward class in some respects relative to this research journey that you're on. [Advanced Qualitative 3] is messier, but I think it'll be really fascinating.

Interviewer: [0:51:31.0] Yeah, and I mean, it makes sense it would be messier given also the stage that they're at in their own growth as scholars.

Site A Instructor: [0:51:37.0] Yes, which is not what they would have thought in [Introductory Qualitative 1]. They would have thought it had gotten clearer. And it's just like, nope, that's a lie.

Interviewer: [0:51:43.0] It is a lie. [Speaker 3] I just wanted to open it up, if you had any questions for Site A Instructor.

Site A Instructor: [0:51:49.0] Yeah, hit me.

Speaker 3: [0:51:52.0] Honestly, the biggest question I had was about did you say all of your students have access to [QUALITATIVE SOFTWARE]

Site A Instructor: [0:52:01.0] Yes

Speaker 3: Is that through your department or, or is it, just like through the class? Like if they enroll in the class, they get access to that program?

Site A Instructor: [0:52:09.0] Oh, no. It's just software that they're, that's available to them through the university. Like all students at [my institution] have access to [QUALITATIVE SOFTWARE] for free.

Speaker 3: [0:52:17.0] Oh, cool. That was my big question. Yeah.

Site A Instructor: [0:52:19.0] Yeah, we, they, there's a, there's a pretty substantial chunk of quantitative software. Undergraduates generally don't download that stuff. They're like, I don't even know what those letters are, but it's available to them if they want it. But when, when we got here, there was a lot of conversation about which of the systems we wanted. I don't, [QUALITATIVE SOFTWARE] is not my favorite, but it works the best with the library systems. And so in conversation with the libraries, which are amazing, there was an agreement that in vivo was probably the best fit across the university because that was ultimately the goal was to offer, I think some of it is also related, [Speaker 3], if I'm super frank to grant getting, because you know, some of it, like a lot of, a lot of grant applications, like there has to, you have to incorporate some kind of software relative to qual to convince them that you're doing something analytic. And so I think that was part of it too. But yeah, so all the students have access to [QUALITATIVE SOFTWARE]. Some of them love it, some of them hate it, some of them don't even know what it is. But it's really nice just because since the library system was a part of that decision making, they actually have like like research librarians that students can go make appointments with that they're like, I have opened the software and now I don't know what to do with it. So that's handy.

Interviewer: [0:53:43.0] What's your favorite software?

Site A Instructor: [0:53:45.0] I don't know that I have a favorite software. [QUALITATIVE SOFTWARE] is the easiest to use for me, but honestly, it's not because there's anything like intuitively better about [QUALITATIVE SOFTWARE], it's just because that's what I used as a doc student. And so I know how to make it go. But [QUALITATIVE SOFTWARE], there are moments when it's like, I look at it and I'm like, I know that you can do this thing, but I don't know how to make you do that thing. So then I'm like, googling YouTube or I'm like writing to one of the librarians like, Hello, it's me again. I have this question and I know it's a me problem, but I don't know how to solve it. And they're always delightful and they're always like, Oh, it's okay. I keep them employed and busy, I guess. I don't know.

Interviewer: [0:54:30.0] Do your students use software in [Advanced Qualitative 3] or is it variable depending on kind of their own preference

Site A Instructor: [0:54:36.0] It's up to them, they pick their poison. They decide, you know, earlier iterations of qual, they're, again, we kind of throw them into it and some of them are like, 'it's the best thing ever.' A lot of them are like, 'it's not doing anything.' And that's always just, that's always the reaction. And I always just have to laugh and I try not to laugh out loud, but I cannot help it. But I'm like, 'That is right. Welcome to qualitative research.' It's just the

bestest, without fail. 'It's not, it's not doing my analysis.' 'That's right. You do that.' It's amazing. But anyway, so you know, so they get their feet wet and a lot of them decide that they want their feet dry, and the other ones decide they want to go out into the ocean, which is also fine.

Interviewer: [0:55:21.0] So thinking about the semester, two questions related to kind of the logistics of of inviting students. First, is there a particular set of weeks or a week where there's more of a focus on data analysis than other weeks?

Site A Instructor: [0:55:39.0] Let me look at the syllabus right quick. Choo choo, choo, choo. There's also random blank pages in that word document, [Interviewer]. Just so we're clear. I can't get rid of them. I'd turn it into a PDF and delete them, but as a word document, I can't. I can't make them get out.

Interviewer: [0:56:02.0] I'm not a fan.

Site A Instructor: [0:56:04.0] Such a stupid problem. So I am anticipating. So the first four weeks are just really going to be like this methodological conservatism issue that we're talking about. Week five is going to start some of the wading into the mess and trying to do something with it. So week five, week six. Week seven to some degree. Those are probably the best weeks. The rest of the weeks, there's going to be some of it, but there's also going to be like, that's when more of the class is more student led. So I can't guarantee what that's going to be. So those are probably the best the best chunks of week, so five, six, seven, so that's, what is that, [DATES], and say definitively there will be something.

Interviewer: [0:57:02.0] With those three weeks, be three weeks that we could get recorded.

Site A Instructor: [0:57:11.0] Yes.

Interviewer: [0:57:12.0] What do you feel would be the most straightforward way for a recording to happen? Just some options, we could have a Zoom, a Zoom room set up and record there, and what gets picked up gets picked up? I can mail you a recording device. That would put a little bit more workload on you. Or do you have other ideas

Site A Instructor: [0:57:44.0] So so I've given students the choice. Part of the syllabus is they're able to join class virtually at least once over the course of the semester. We're assuming we're going to stay face to face the whole semester.

Interviewer: [0:57:54.0] Right, right.

Site A Instructor: [0:57:56.0] In a state where there is no mask mandate, I mean

Interviewer: [0:57:58.0] I saw that.

Site A Instructor: [0:57:59.0] It can only end well. I will say the university has a mask mandate, but I mean, when they're going out to the freaking bars and shit, I mean, anyway.

Interviewer: [0:58:10.0] Do you have a vaccine mandate?

Site A Instructor: [0:58:12.0] No, because [this state] doesn't allow one.

Interviewer: [0:58:15.0] Oh, ok.

Site A Instructor: [0:58:16.0] This state, this is like a whole different tangent, I won't get on it. This state passed a law in [MONTH] that universities, any vaccines that were already FDA approved that were mandated could stay mandated, but no new vaccines could be mandated. And so the faculty Senate is actually like, we're right now like, there's a lot of like, there's a lot of listserv action because it's like, this is bullshit, but and so now there's a question of like, what do we do to fight this state? Because [school] just mandated vaccines and that's another [regional] school. But because I have family in [city], like they have a Democratic governor, we do not. We are [state]. So anyway, so all that is to say, we are currently face to face. Students have the option of joining class virtually, no questions asked once this semester, because the provost has been really adamant, 'We need to return to face to face' and I'm like, your ass is sitting in an office but cool, you do you. And so it is entirely possible that there will be a student already on Zoom anyway. If you want to use your Zoom account, I could let you know ahead of time that a student needed to join virtually, and then we could just share that link with the student to join to through that. Because I know that like if you save it to the cloud, like it'll do a transcript for you, which is really handy dandy, or I mean, or we could use my zoom account. It doesn't matter and I can just send you the transcript. It doesn't matter, but all that is to say there is equipment in the classroom. There is like a built-in classroom microphone and there is like a pivoting webcam thing. So we could try zoom like maybe Week Five or Six, and then if that's just a fail, then we can all accept that.

Interviewer: [1:00:07.0] Sure.

Site A Instructor: And then try something different.

Interviewer: [1:00:09.0] Yeah. That sounds great. And so what's easiest for you? Is it easiest for you to use your zoom link or my zoom link? It doesn't matter to me. I just want to make it easy for you.

Site A Instructor: [1:00:19.0] If if we use yours, which again, I have no objection to, I'm going to need to be a co-host just so I can like monitor, because especially if there's a student online, I'm going to need to be able to, like potentially create breakout rooms. Like if students are in small groups, that that student can join a small group. So, I mean, we can, we can figure that out, but I mean, it doesn't matter. I mean, I think the most straightforward thing is, is for me to use my Zoom account, because that way I have complete control. But I also like I'm not I'm not opposed to using yours. And so yeah.

Interviewer: [1:00:54.0] That sounds fine with me if you're okay sending along the transcript that's produced. And then what are your thoughts on either myself or [Speaker 3] being present there? Is that an okay thing or would you prefer for us just to have access to the recording?

Site A Instructor: [1:01:16.0] It's up to you and it's up to the students too I would say, I mean, definitely the students need to have a say. I don't think they're going to mind. I mean, at this point, they know how research works. They know that people have to, people have to interact with people to have research most times. And so I don't think they would object, but I mean, they might. And it's, I used to be in teacher education and so like I would go and observe student teachers. And in some respects it may be very much like when you're like sitting next to a seventh grader and they're like, 'Who are you? Why are you here?' You know, and so I think that some of that, if the point is just to sort of observe, I mean, I think that's fine. I mean, especially like with a camera off or something. I mean, it could be kinda creepy weird for someone to just be there for 3 hours, just to be like, 'hello.'

Interviewer: [1:02:09.0] Yeah. And so I'll say that the plan was for us not to be present, if that's okay with you, and then just dependent upon the students who are interested in participating, just reminding them that it is being recorded for the purposes of us learning from the the interaction.

Site A Instructor: [1:02:30.0] Yeah. I think they'll be into it. I mean I really do. I think they'll be, I think they'll be pumped. But yeah, I mean, like, I don't know, I think part of this, like I used to be a high school teacher, right? I mean, I did that for years. So the idea of being observed is, whatever. Come on over. So, yeah, but I mean, I think the students will be cool.

Interviewer: [1:02:48.0] Ok.

Site A Instructor: [1:02:49.0] I think, I assume no, but I think.

Interviewer: [1:02:51.0] Right. And so then my, my final question is, is there a a week and a time that you all meet where it would be possible for me to pop in and invite them to participate in the study and talk a little bit about the study? I would anticipate, you know, just like a five-minute overview and then just opening it for any questions that they might have.

Site A Instructor: [1:03:12.0] Sure. I mean, next week, the next week, the next week. I mean, any any week before week five is fine.

Interviewer: [1:03:17.0] Okay. All right. I will, is it okay if I just send you an email after I look at my schedule and then I'll.

Site A Instructor: [1:03:25.0] Yep, [inaudible] [DAYS OF WEEK AND TIME]

Interviewer: [1:03:30.0] Oh, that that should work out fine. [TIME]. So you only teach at night or mostly teach at night?

Site A Instructor: [1:03:38.0] Most of the, so not exclusively, but most of the, most of the classes that are required for either different doctoral programs or the cert are in the evening because again, so many of them are like full time teachers, principals, [inaudible] etc.

Interviewer: [1:03:53.0] Okay, okay. That makes sense. Okay. Well, excellent. So I'll email you either later today or tomorrow regarding which day and which week?

Site A Instructor: [1:04:05.0] Yeah, we'll be there every week, so it doesn't matter.

Interviewer: [1:04:07.0] Sorry, which day and which time. Okay. This has been fantastic, [Site A Instructor].

Site A Instructor: [1:04:14.0] Oh, well good.

Interviewer: [1:04:15.0] I was going to say, just, I took a note unrelated to, related to something you said. I don't know if you've read anything that Stephanie Kershbaum has written. She's in English and she just, in the field of English, and she just moved to Seattle, the University of Washington, and she has been writing. So she's in disability studies, and she's she's she's a deaf scholar and she's written some really, really, nice, well, really radical critiques of transcription

Site A Instructor: [1:04:49.0] Nice

Interviewer: and interviewing, and recently. I can send you a chapter that

Site A Instructor: [1:04:52.0] Yes

Interviewer: just came out where she asks these really interesting questions. Provocative and kind of damning questions about how transcription has been conceptualized, from the perspective of a deaf scholar and takes on this like deaf participant, deaf researcher? What you're telling me, what would it mean

Site A Instructor: [1:05:12.0] Yes

Interviewer: for my identity? And she also takes on Jeffersonian transcription as well.

Site A Instructor: [1:05:18.0] Yeah, yeah. So yeah, I would love that. A group of doctoral students and I. So I taught a class, I don't know, a year or so ago that was, it was, it was analysis of social interaction and talk. And so we're writing a paper together about just their process of recognizing the, just the, the humanness, the subjectivity-ness of of transcription as a process. And that would be amazing. Yes, please.

Interviewer: [1:05:47.0] Yeah. I'll send over her stuff and she's just like one to, I just learned so much from her thinking. She's just one to kind of follow as she develops new ideas. So anyway. All right. Well, thank you so much for your time and I will see you soon for other things, too. I know we have

Site A Instructor: [1:06:06.0] We got to make a program.

Interviewer: [1:06:07.0] Yes.

Site A Instructor: [1:06:10.0] It'll be amazing. It'll kick ass. It'll be great.

Interviewer: [1:06:12.0] I agree. I agree. Well, thank you so much, [Site A Instructor], and have a good rest of the week.

Site A Instructor: [1:06:16.0] For sure, [Speaker 3], it was a delight to meet you.

Speaker 3: [1:06:19.0] It was so nice to meet you, too. Yeah.

Site A Instructor: [1:06:21.0] And I'm glad that my dog behaved because normally he is an absolute fool. So I closed all the blinds, but he's got, like, big satellite ears, so he's just like, I can hear all the things. It doesn't matter.

Interviewer: [1:06:35.0] So sweet.

Site A Instructor: [1:06:36.0] Well, he has his moments. All right, y'all have a lovely rest of the day and I'll talk to you later.

Interviewer: [1:06:41.0] Thanks (Pre interview – [MONTH, DAY, YEAR], Pos. 2-134)